details of direct contributions to the Swadeshi company, he said. Once the funds swelled, they would be converted into shares that would be the property of the common people, with prominent contributors being appointed trustees to manage those shares. Dividends would be used to train people in maritime technology. Stating that the original appeal issued by *India* was being printed as leaflets and distributed widely, he asked readers to write to him for copies. He reminded them that Rs 2 lakh in two months was the target. Considering this stiff goal, what had been raised was way too low—only Rs 64-6-2 had been collected in the first week. The very fact that the Swadeshi steamers had started sailing for the last few months had resulted in a considerable gain for the public: with BI reducing passenger fares and freight rates, the national gain had been calculated to be in the tune of Rs 10 lakh.[122] One could scarcely imagine how much more benefits would accrue to the nation if the Swadeshi company succeeded. What was contributing Rs 1 compared to these gains, he asked.[123]

Even an incurable romantic-idealist such as Bharati could not keep up hopes for long. For in fact the response had been anything but encouraging. 'When Bhagiratha was looking up to the skies for the Ganga to flow, what if all he got was a few drops of rain!' But he would still not give up hope. The first set of contributions came from Pondicherry. There had been some delay in sending the appeal to other parts; once they were circulated more could be expected. Even if similar amounts could be collected from every little town, he reassured himself, the target could be met. In the end, some 150 people contributed Rs 215-13-8. And in the first instance only Rs 150 had been remitted barely meeting the price of six shares. After two months, all contributions had ceased. 'Shame! Shame!', Bharati cried out in embarrassment and fallen pride. How does one awaken the sleeping masses, he despaired.[124]

Though the amount raised was small, the social base of the contributors was wide. From the names of contributors, we can discern that people from various castes and religions, from across a wide geographic spread had